

Age Matters

Latest video-recordings of George Fernandes justify his long-estranged wife Laila Kabir's version that his demand for a JD(U) ticket to contest Lok Sabha elections should be turned down as a sulking child's antics ("The Dragon Slayer", May 4). The criterion of age restriction should be applicable to politicians as well, like it is for judges, government-employees and others entitled to pay and pension from exchequers.

MADHU AGARWAL, Delhi

Systems Failure

We are a country of habitual laggards, corrupt officials and most unpatriotic people ("Fundamental Faultlines", May 4). Our self-interests are above the interests of the nation. We have to rid ourselves of all our lacunae before our country can ever hope to become a fore-runner in the comity of nations.

V.K. TANGRI,

Dehradun

The Cost of Living

It is true that the falling rate of inflation does not provide any relief for the common man who is sandwiched between painfully high prices of essential items on one side and the pink slip on the other ("Price Vs Inflation", May 4). It's also unfortunate that our learned economists, who were taking credit for the high rate of growth a few months ago, put all the

blame on global meltdown for the condition of the Indian economy today.

J.N. MAHANTY, Puri

Prevention Cures

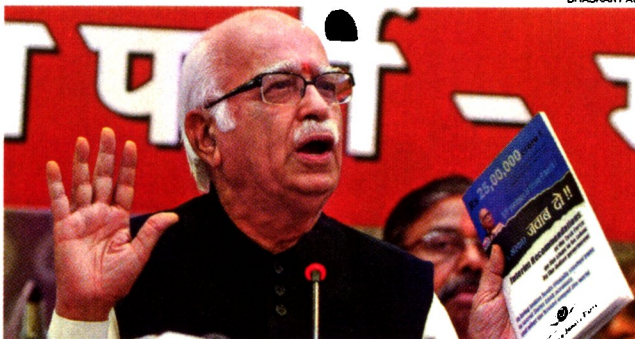
Counselling of students and parents together every year in the beginning of the term along with top police officials will go a long way in harmonising relations among the student community. ("Monitoring a Menace", May 4). Ragging and eve-teasing should be

upheaval of unthinkable proportions ("The New Terror Threat", April 27). Shall we be caught napping as always or will our national security managers make contingency plans to reduce the effect of a catastrophe?

R.J. KHURANA, Bhopal

Political Gimmick

L.K. Advani's makeover also exposes increasingly deteriorating and degenerating Indian political environment where politi-



BHASKAR PAUL

“The issue of black money in Swiss banks, which has become good election fodder for some politicians, seems to be based on assumptions. An in-depth probe is needed.”

DR MOTUPALLI S. PRASAD, Chennai

made non-bailable offences. Swift and harsh punishment like arrest and barring such students from entering any other college would certainly act as deterrents.

M.M. KALE,

via www.indiatoday.in

Wake-up Call

With terror outfits getting bolder in their attacks, the subcontinent may see an

cians are swiftly adopting properties of a chameleon, changing colours according to the power equation and thus converting politics into a free-for-all political circus ("The New Avatar", April 20). It is nothing but a desperate pursuit of power in the run-up to the world's biggest democratic exercise.

DR. VITULL K. GUPTA, Bathinda

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

JUNE 16-30, 1979

The Plot Thickens

The ghost of Lalit Narain Mishra, once Indira Gandhi's blue-eyed boy and also her controversial fund-raiser, who was killed in a bomb blast at Samastipur on the cold and foggy evening of January 2, 1975, has come to haunt the nation again. The ghost has been resurrected by Ram Nath Goenka's enterprising *Indian Express* newspaper chain in a series of reports by its chief reporter Braj Mohan Sinha, an Anand Margi, and executive editor Arun Shourie.

Their articles, based on a report by noted jurist V.M. Tarkunde, pointed an accusing finger at Ram Bilas Jha, a former member of the Bihar Legislative Council. The paper described him as a "class associate" of Yashpal Kapoor, Mrs Gandhi's Man Friday. The Tarkunde report also alleged that the Central Bureau of Investigation's probe into the murder was "deliberately abandoned, indeed sabotaged, probably at the instance of Mrs Indira Gandhi."

Arun B. Louis and Farzand Ahmed



L.N. MISHRA WITH
INDIRA GANDHI

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